

Chuong Nguyen

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego - B.S. Computer Science
Degree conferred June 2026 | GPA: 3.803

Sep 2022 - Jun 2026

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Co-first authors marked with *. My name is in bold.

[2026] X Pi*, Q Yang*, **C Nguyen***, H Shen. *Bridge Human Interpretation and Machine Representation With Explicit Specification For Qualitative Data Analysis In LLM Era*. International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2026 - Position Paper (Poster) (arXiv:2601.11739).

[2026] T Smith*, **C Nguyen***, Q Yang, O Bandopadhyay, Y Su, N Polikarpova, X Pi. *QualAlign: Benchmarking Automated Qualitative Coding Against Human Schemas*. Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) 2026.

[2025] X Pi*, Q Yang*, **C Nguyen***. *LOGOS: LLM-driven End-to-End Grounded Theory Development and Schema Induction for Qualitative Research*. arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.24294.

[2024] A Smithwick*, **C Nguyen***, E Gorial*, N Tran*, AM Flores, INS Munyaka. *"Parent seeking Roblox Safety Help": Comparing Parental Roblox Concerns to Roblox Offerings*. IEEE ISTAS 2024, pp. 1-9.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Prof. Zhiting Hu's Group - HDSI, UC San Diego

Apr 2025 - Present

- LOGOS: led implementation of an LLM framework that turns unstructured evidence into hierarchical schemas (semantic clustering, relation-aware graph reasoning); 88.2% match with expert schemas.
- QualAlign (COLM 2026): co-built a qualitative-coding benchmark and ran baselines across metric families.
- ICML 2026 position paper: co-defined a framework for evaluating automated qualitative analysis.
- Episteme (in progress): co-building a deep research agent harness (tool use, evidence synthesis, evaluation).
- Fine-tuned LLMs with SFT/GRPO; explored test-time scaling and process reward models.

Research Assistant, Ujima Lab - UC San Diego

Sep 2023 - Oct 2024

- Beauty Filter: analyzed cultural bias in filter-driven facial enhancements; migrated analysis to a remote server.
- Smart Mirror: Raspberry Pi + DeepFace/Retina for real-time facial analysis in a public art installation.
- Co-authored "Parent seeking Roblox Safety Help" (IEEE ISTAS 2024); topic modeling on 10,000+ Reddit posts and survey of 100 participants.

Early Research Scholars Program - UC San Diego

Sep 2023 - Jun 2024

- Built a hate-crime news pipeline with SerpAPI, NewsPlease, DBSCAN, MeanShift, and the OpenAI API.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Software Developer, Zooseeker

Apr 2024 - Jun 2024

- Database schema, Android UI revamp, and documentation for a zoo navigation app.

ACM AI - UC San Diego

Oct 2022 - Jan 2023

Credit Card Fraud Detector

- Compared KNN, RF, decision trees, SVM, and logistic regression; built and demoed a fraud detection web app.

SKILLS

Technical: Python, Java, C++, SQL, PyTorch, Hugging Face, vLLM, LLM APIs, scikit-learn, Pandas, Docker, Git, Linux, AI coding agents

Research: LLM agents (tool use, deep research), human-aligned LLM evaluation, LLM-assisted qualitative analysis, SFT/GRPO, RAG, knowledge representation, data mining

Languages: English, Vietnamese

AWARDS & LEADERSHIP

- Provost Honors - UC San Diego
- Machine Learning Specialization - Coursera
- Volunteer Youth Leader - Vietnamese Eucharistic Youth Movement (2022 - Present)
- Peer Mentor - UCSD Mentor Collective (2024)